

A *variable* is a label for a value you want to use in your program.

Variable names in Python follow two main rules:

- They must contain only letters, underscores, and numbers.
- They must start with a letter or underscore.

Good variable names are short but descriptive:

```
first_name = 'albert'  
last_name = 'einstein'  
username = 'einsteina'  
age = 42
```

A variable can hold a small piece of information, or it can hold many gigabytes of data.